

QUE

90-Day Strategic Plan

Expanded strategic suggestions (ordered by severity) · Product + GTM scorecard · Design-partner & raise gates · Companion to Que Technical Documentation

Que is the schema-only stitch layer between messy sources and production jobs.

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1. Category decision & buyer

Choose A, kill B. A = schema-only stitch → production job tool. B = lightweight catalog. Catalog + lineage is a bloody ocean (Atlan, Alation, Collibra, DataHub, Purview, dbt Explorer, etc.). “Pretty schema graph” alone dies.

- **Buyer (PO):** Head of Data / Platform — owns pipeline quality and AI policy.
- **Champion:** Staff data / analytics engineer — daily promote/reject user.
- **Blocker to neutralize:** CISO / Legal — schema-only one-pager + audit, not lime-green diagrams.

Ban phrases: “AI workspace” · “SchemaGraph” · “Notion for data” · “modern catalog.”

2. Seven strategic suggestions (by severity)

P0 1. Narrow the product to one job-to-be-done

Ship for 90 days on only this: *Connect two sources → suggest joins → human promote/reject → emit a reviewable stitch job (SQL + lineage note).*

Do

- First-class sources: Postgres + Excel/CSV only until the loop is addictive.
- Promote/reject is the habit metric (actions per partner per week).
- Chat drafts the job; it is not the headline product.

Freeze / cut

- Fancy PDF/PNG export theater; multi-connector vanity (Mongo/Databricks polish).
- LLM cosplay / open-ended “AI workspace” framing.

Pass

A partner completes 2-source stitch → promote → job artifact without a Zoom babysitter.

P0 2. Make the output money

Export must plug into something people already run: **dbt PR (default)**, Airflow/Dagster DAG stub, Snowflake worksheet, GitHub PR. "Download JSON" is not value capture.

Do

- One deep integration first — recommended: GitHub PR with dbt model + basic tests.
- Every artifact: SQL + lineage note + approved join IDs + schema-only attestation stub.
- Demo must answer yes: "Does this change production without copy-paste?"

Pass

At least one design partner merges or schedules a Que-emitted artifact.

P1 3. Prove the privacy claim with evidence

Publish a one-pager: what never leaves the customer network, what samples look like, prompt redaction, audit log of schema packs. Sales ammo, not engineering trivia.

Do

- Attach attestation to every job export (human summary + machine-readable stub).
- Security call script treats CISO as blocker to clear, not buyer.

Pass

Partner Legal/Security can approve a pilot from the one-pager alone.

P0 4. Get 5 design partners before fundraising

Not "users." Named teams with weekly calls and written pain ("we spend N hours/week reconciling Excel↔Postgres joins"). If you cannot get five, the market is telling you something.

ICP

- Series B–D SaaS or fintech; 8–40 sources; no Collibra-scale budget.
- Already on dbt/Airflow/Dagster; pressure to use AI safely.

Pass

Five named orgs on the calendar with documented hours/week pain baseline.

P1 5. Pricing that matches the buyer

Do not freemium into oblivion. Think **per workspace / per connected source** with a hard schema-only guarantee. Free-forever catalog clones do not win this war.

Do

- Pilot: fixed fee or \$0 + case-study rights.
- Paid target: workspace base + \$/source; SSO/audit as later enterprise add-on.
- Do not lead with per-seat pricing aimed at individuals who cannot sign a PO.

Pass

Pricing sheet exists for Head of Data; ≥1 paid or priced LOI pilot.

P0 6. Kill ambiguity in positioning

Que is the schema-only stitch layer between messy sources and production jobs.

Do

- Hero = brand + one sentence + one CTA (design partner / stitch demo).
- Competitive frame: Cursor-for-joins / dbt-adjacent — not Alation/Colibra.

Pass

A stranger repeats the tattoo sentence after a 60-second pitch.

P0 7. Raise only when you have proof

Raise a real seed only when you have **one of**: paid design partners, a measurable time-saved case study, or a proprietary inference loop that improves with approved joins (HITL graph as training signal). Until then: friends/family or bootstrap. Demo credentials and fixture Databricks get crushed in diligence.

Hygiene

- Before diligence: retire customer-facing `stitch_*` brand debt (product is Que).

3. 90-day GTM + product scorecard

Metric	Target (D90)	D30	D60	D90
Design partners (named, weekly)	5	2	4	5
Core loop completions (no babysitter)	≥10	3	7	10+
Promote/reject actions / partner / week	≥5	2	4	5+
Artifacts merged/scheduled in their stack	≥1	0	1	2+
Privacy one-pager approved by partner Sec	Yes	Draft	Yes	Yes
Written hours-saved case study	1+	—	Draft	1+
Paid pilot or priced LOI	1+	—	Talks	1+

4. Phased plan

Days 1–30 — Nail the loop

- Freeze non-Postgres/Excel work; strip positioning to the tattoo sentence.
- Ship promote/reject → SQL + lineage job as the only happy path.
- Start GitHub → dbt PR export (even if rough).
- Draft privacy one-pager; outreach to ~15 ICP accounts aiming for 5 partners.

Days 31–60 — Make output money

- First partner opens/merges a Que PR or schedules SQL.
- Persist approve/reject graph (moat seed / Gate C).
- Weekly partner calls; capture N hours/week pain in writing.
- Pricing sheet v0 for Head of Data conversations.

Days 61–90 — Proof or pivot

- Hit 5 partners or formally revise ICP/JTBD.
- Publish case study + privacy pack; kill customer-facing `stitch_*` debt.
- Decide raise only if Gate A, B, or C is green — else bootstrap another cycle.

5. Design-partner offer (script)

We help teams stitch two messy sources under a hard schema-only AI policy, get human join approval, and open a dbt PR (or equivalent) your engineers can merge — in under a day for the first stitch.

You get: 90-day pilot, weekly 30-minute working session, priority on your two sources.

We get: written pain baseline (hours/week), promote/reject usage, and a quote if it works. No multi-year lock-in.

Ask: “How many hours/week does your team spend reconciling joins across Excel/Postgres (or warehouse ↔ app DB)?”

6. Demo script (kills “fancy notepad”)

Step	Show	Say
1	Connect A + B	Metadata + capped samples only — rows never train a public model.
2	Suggested joins	Confidence + why; you promote/reject — humans own truth.
3	Job artifact	SQL + lineage note + attestation — not a screenshot.
4	GitHub dbt PR	This lands where you already ship. No copy-paste graveyard.
5	Next sync	Approved joins persist — the graph gets smarter for your org.

7. Raise gates

Gate A — Paid Paid design partner(s) or priced LOI.	Gate B — Case study Named team + measurable hours saved on join discovery / stitch.	Gate C — Moat HITL approved-join graph measurably improves inference for that org.
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Until one gate is green: friends/family or bootstrap. Fixture connectors and a rebrand on a scaffold are not a seed thesis.